

UNDERGRADUATE ATTENDANCE RELAXATION GUIDELINES 2026

Document code: NIT/AA/ARL/2026

Version: 1.0

Effective from: 1 August 2026

Classification: Academic policy - approved for student reference

1. Purpose and relationship to the attendance policy

1.1 These guidelines establish the limited circumstances in which an undergraduate student with attendance below the ordinary minimum may request relaxation for a particular course.

1.2 The ordinary requirement remains 75 percent attendance in each registered course under the Undergraduate Attendance Policy 2026. Relaxation is an exception considered on documented grounds and is not an automatic entitlement.

1.3 These guidelines apply separately to every affected course. Approval in one course does not establish eligibility in another course.

2. Basic eligibility

2.1 A student may apply when final attendance in the affected course is between 65 percent and 74 percent, inclusive.

2.2 A student whose attendance is below 65 percent is ordinarily not eligible under these guidelines and must repeat the course when it is next offered.

2.3 An application may be considered only when the shortage is connected to one or more permitted grounds stated in section 3 and the student has supplied reasonable supporting evidence.

2.4 The student must have completed the essential laboratory, studio, clinical or field components identified by the department. Relaxation shall not be used to waive a compulsory practical requirement.

3. Permitted grounds

- a. Illness, hospitalization, injury or a medically advised period of rest supported by records from a registered medical practitioner.
- b. A serious family emergency, bereavement or another exceptional personal circumstance supported by appropriate documents.
- c. Official representation of the Institute in an approved academic, cultural or sports activity when attendance credit could not reasonably be granted under the ordinary policy.
- d. Disruption caused by a documented public emergency, natural event or transport closure affecting the student's ability to attend.
- e. An established administrative or timetable error that cannot be fully corrected through the ordinary attendance-record correction process.

4. Grounds normally not accepted

- a. Personal travel, vacations, social events or employment undertaken without prior academic approval.
- b. Preparation for another course, examination, competition or private certification.
- c. Failure to monitor published attendance or reliance on an estimated attendance percentage.
- d. A general request for leniency without documents or a specific explanation of the affected period.

5. Application deadline

5.1 The completed application must reach the department at least seven working days before the first scheduled end-semester examination for the programme.

5.2 When the shortage arises or becomes known after that deadline, the application must be submitted within two working days of the relevant event or publication of the final attendance record.

5.3 A delayed application may be accepted only when the student demonstrates that timely submission was not reasonably possible.

6. Application procedure

6.1 The student shall submit Form ATT-07 separately for each course in which relaxation is requested. The form must state the course code, recorded attendance, period of absence and ground relied upon.

6.2 The application shall first be submitted to the faculty adviser, who will check completeness and forward it to the course instructor and Head of Department.

6.3 The student should retain a copy or electronic acknowledgement showing the date of submission. Submission alone does not permit the student to appear in the examination.

7. Supporting documents

7.1 Medical applications should include a certificate stating the relevant period and, where available, consultation, admission or discharge records. A diagnosis need not be disclosed beyond what is necessary to establish inability to attend.

7.2 Applications based on Institute representation must include the approval issued by the responsible faculty member or office and the confirmed activity schedule.

7.3 For a family emergency or public disruption, the committee may accept official notices, travel interruption records, declarations or other material appropriate to the circumstances.

7.4 The Institute may verify a submitted document with the issuing organization. Fabricated or altered evidence may be referred for disciplinary action.

8. Departmental verification

8.1 The course instructor shall confirm the number of sessions conducted, the student's recorded attendance and whether essential assessed activities were completed.

8.2 The Head of Department shall confirm that any attendance correction request has been resolved before the relaxation application is considered.

8.3 Where records are incomplete, the department shall make reasonable efforts to verify them. Uncertainty created solely by an institutional recording failure shall not be held against the student.

9. Attendance Relaxation Committee

9.1 Each school shall constitute an Attendance Relaxation Committee consisting of the Head of School or nominee, one senior faculty member and an Academic Affairs representative.

9.2 A member directly involved in a disputed record should disclose that involvement and may provide information but shall not determine the application alone.

9.3 The committee may approve, reject or seek limited additional information. Decisions must be based on the applicable percentage, the permitted ground, supporting evidence and completion of essential course work.

10. Decision standards

10.1 Attendance between 70 percent and 74 percent may be relaxed where a permitted ground is supported and essential course requirements have been completed.

10.2 Attendance between 65 percent and 69 percent requires evidence of serious circumstances and a specific recommendation from the Head of Department.

10.3 No relaxation may increase the recorded attendance percentage. Approval only changes examination eligibility for the stated course and semester.

10.4 The committee shall apply comparable standards to comparable cases while considering the individual duration and effect of the documented circumstances.

11. Communication and examination status

11.1 The decision shall identify the student, course, recorded percentage, outcome and any condition attached to approval. Reasons should be stated briefly when an application is rejected.

11.2 The department shall communicate the decision through the official student communication channel and update the examination eligibility record.

11.3 When a decision remains pending on the examination date, provisional appearance may be authorized only in writing by the Dean of Academic Affairs. The answer script shall not be evaluated if the application is later rejected, unless an appeal changes the outcome.

12. Conditions attached to approval

12.1 The committee may require completion of missed laboratory work, an additional academic task or another reasonable activity directly connected to the missed instruction.

12.2 Any condition must be stated in the written decision with a completion date. Failure to satisfy the condition may result in withdrawal of the relaxation before result processing.

12.3 A fee, donation or unrelated service requirement shall not be imposed as a condition of attendance relaxation.

13. Appeal

13.1 A student may appeal a rejection to the Dean of Academic Affairs within three working days of receiving the decision.

13.2 The appeal must identify a material error in the attendance record, application of the eligibility range, consideration of evidence or procedure followed by the committee.

13.3 New evidence may be considered when the student explains why it was not reasonably available with the original application.

13.4 The Dean's decision shall be final for the semester, without limiting correction of a later-discovered institutional record error.

14. Records, privacy and reporting

14.1 Applications and decisions shall be retained as restricted academic records for at least one academic year after publication of the relevant course result.

14.2 Medical and personal documents shall be accessed only by staff involved in verification, decision or appeal and shall not be reproduced in general departmental reports.

14.3 Academic Affairs may prepare anonymized statistics showing the number of applications, percentage ranges, outcomes and grounds for policy review.

15. Commencement

15.1 These guidelines take effect on 1 August 2026 and apply to courses beginning on or after that date.

15.2 They shall be reviewed after the 2026-27 academic year. Any amendment must be issued through a numbered notification.

Issued by:

Dean of Academic Affairs

Northbridge Institute of Technology